

Jeffrey Weng
翁哲瑞

Department of Sociology
National Taiwan University
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Appointments

NATIONAL TAIWAN UNIVERSITY
Assistant Professor of Sociology, 2021–present

STANFORD UNIVERSITY
Shorenstein Postdoctoral Fellow on Contemporary Asia, 2020–21

Education

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY
Ph.D. in Sociology, 2020
M.A. in Sociology, 2014

YALE UNIVERSITY
B.A. in Political Science and International Studies, 2008

Publications

BOOK
Weng, Jeffrey. Forthcoming (November 2026). *With One Voice: Mandarin's Conquest of China*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.

IN PROGRESS
Weng, Jeffrey. "Making Overseas Chinese: The Republic of China on Taiwan and Chinese Language Education in the United States after 1949." Revise and resubmit at *Sociology Lens*.

PEER-REVIEWED
ARTICLES
Weng, Jeffrey. 2023. "Stop the Presses! Publishing Chinese Character Simplification, 1935–1936." *Harvard Journal of Asiatic Studies* 83(2): 333–364.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "End of an Era: Transforming Language and Society in Japan, Korea, and Vietnam, ca. 1870–1950." *European Journal of Sociology* 61(2): 269–299.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "Uneasy Companions: Language and Human Collectivities in the Remaking of Chinese Society in the Early Twentieth Century." *Theory & Society* 49(1):75–100.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2018. "What is Mandarin? The Social Project of Language Standardization in Early Republican China." *Journal of Asian Studies* 77(3): 611–633.

BOOK CHAPTERS
Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "Vernacular Language Movement." *Oxford Bibliographies in Chinese Studies*. Ed. Tim Wright. New York: Oxford University Press.

Lie, John and Jeffrey Weng. 2020. "East Asia." Pp. 129–146 in *The Wiley Blackwell Companion to Race, Ethnicity, and Nationalism*, edited by John Stone, Polly Rizova, Rutledge M. Dennis, and Xiaoshuo Hou. Chichester: John Wiley & Sons.

BOOK REVIEWS

Weng, Jeffrey. 2024. "Sound, Meaning, Shape: The Phonologist Wei Jiangong (1901–1980) between Language Study and Language Planning, by Mariana Münning." *Bulletin of the Institute of Modern History, Academia Sinica* 121: 191–197.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2023. "Kingdom of Characters: The Language Revolution That Made China Modern, by Jing Tsu." *The Journal of Asian Studies* 82(3): 471–472.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2017. "The Rural Modern: Reconstructing the Self and State in Republican China, by Kate Merkel-Hess." *The China Review* 17(3):190–194.

Invited talks

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "What is Mandarin? Designing a New Language for a New Nation." International Chinese Language Program, National Taiwan University. Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "The Transformation of Language and Society in Japan, Korea, and Vietnam, c. 1870–1950." Global Asia Research Center, National Taiwan University. Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "Out in the Field in the Archives: One Historical Sociologist's Perspective on the Discipline." Department of Sociology, National Chengchi University, Taipei, Taiwan

Weng, Jeffrey. 2021. "Chinese Character Simplification and the Publishing Industry, 1935–1936." Colloquium. Institute of Modern History, Academia Sinica. Taipei, Taiwan.

Conferences & workshops

Weng, Jeffrey (panel organizer and presenter) 2026. "By the Book: Heritage-Language Education among Taiwanese and Chinese Immigrants to the U.S. since the 1970s." *Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference*. Panel, "The Nation Overseas: Language and Institutions among the Republic of China's Diasporas in the US, Southeast Asia, and Latin America." Vancouver, Canada.

Weng, Jeffrey (chair). 2026. Panel, "Language, Politics, and Contestation." Presenters: Cedric Deschrijver, Tzu-Kai Liu, and Jennifer Wei. *International Workshop on Language and Society*. National Chengchi University, Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2025. "Chinese as a Global Language: Taiwan, China, and Postwar Chinese-Language Education in the United States." *Language and Society Research Network* monthly meeting. Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2024. "Deviance, Determinism, and Denial: China in the Reconsideration of Language in Nationalism and State-Building." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Comparative-Historical Sociology. Roundtable. Montreal, Canada.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2023. "Out of Many Voices, One: Language in the Reinvention of the Chinese Nation." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Comparative-Historical Sociology. Panel, "Historical Sociology of Political and Economic Formations." Philadelphia, PA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2022. "Meritocracy vs. Egalitarianism in Language and Education: China in the 1930s." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Global and Transnational Sociology, refereed roundtable. Los Angeles, CA.

Weng, Jeffrey (panel organizer, chair, and presenter). 2022. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of China's Ethnoracial Majority." *Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference*. Panel, "The Outsiders Within: Contesting Majority and Minority Peoplehood in Modern and Contemporary China." Honolulu, HI.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2021. "Bourdieu in China: Language and Symbolic Power Beyond Western Models." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Regular Session, Sociological Theory.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2021. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of the World's Largest Ethnoracial Group." University of Tokyo / National Taiwan University Sociology Forum. Taipei, Taiwan.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2020. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of the World's Largest Ethnoracial Group." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Panel, "Internal Boundaries and Multinational States." San Francisco, CA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2019. "Hiding in Plain Sight: Language and the Construction of the World's Largest Ethnoracial Group." Center for Culture, Organizations, and Politics Workshop. University of California, Berkeley.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2019. "Who are You Calling Anomalous? Eurocentric Explanations of the Rise of National Standard Languages and the Chinese Case." *The Eleventh International Convention of Asia Scholars*. Panel, "Sounding Chinese: Evolving Notions of Nation, Language and Identity." Leiden University, International Institute for Asian Studies. Leiden, Netherlands.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2019. "Stop the Presses! Character Simplification and the Publishing Industry in China Under the Nationalists, 1935–1936." *Languages and Scripts in China: New Directions in Information and Communications History*. Workshop at Columbia University. New York, NY.

Weng, Jeffrey (panel organizer and presenter). 2019. "Spreading the Word: National Language Education in China in the 1920s and 1930s." *Association for Asian Studies Annual Conference*. Panel, "Finding the Nation's Voice: Language Ideologies and the Remaking of Mandarin in Twentieth-Century Mainland China and Taiwan." Denver, CO.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2018. "The Political Economy of Spelling: The Publishing Industry and Character Simplification in China under the Nationalists, 1935–1936." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Comparative Historical Sociology, refereed roundtable. Philadelphia, PA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2017. "The End of East Asian Linguistic Cosmopolitanism: Japan, Korea, and Vietnam, ca. 1850–1950." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Section on Asia and Asian America, refereed roundtable. Montreal, Canada.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "What is Mandarin? The Invention of a National Standard Language in Early Republican China." *East Asia as Method: Culture, Knowledge, Space*, Institute of East Asian Studies Haas Junior Scholars Program for Doctoral Candidates. Berkeley, CA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "Language, Class, and Nation: The Rise of a National Lingua Franca and the Problem of Equity." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Comparative-Historical Section, Refereed Roundtable. Seattle, WA.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "What is Mandarin? Nationalism and Linguistic Modernity in Early Twentieth Century China." *Colloquium Talk*. Nanjing University, School of Social and Behavioral Sciences. Nanjing, China.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2016. "What is Mandarin? Evolving Notions of Language and Peoplehood in Early Twentieth-Century China." *Language, Power and Identity in Asia: Creating and Crossing Language Boundaries*. Leiden University, International Institute for Asian Studies. Leiden, Netherlands.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2015. "Linguistic Modernity: The Limits of Ideology and State Power in the Creation of Modern Standard Languages." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Theory Section regular session panel, "Theorizing Inequality." Chicago, IL.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2015. "Linguistic Modernity: The Limits of Ideology and State Power in the Creation of Modern Standard Languages." *Junior Theorists Symposium*. Panel, "The State and Globalization." Chicago, IL.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2015. "Linguistic Modernity: The Limits of Ideology and State Power in the Creation of Modern Standard Languages." *Social Science History Association Annual Meeting*. Panel, "Fields and Disciplines." Baltimore, MD.

Weng, Jeffrey. 2014. "Language and Nation-Building in Early Twentieth-Century China: A Critique of Bourdieu." *American Sociological Association Annual Meeting*. Theory Section, refereed roundtable. San Francisco, CA.

Fellowships and grants

2030 Cross-Generation Emerging Young Scholars Grant, Taiwan National Science and Technology Council, 2025–2028 (US\$75,000 per year for 3 years)

Taiwan National Science and Technology Council Grant, 2023–25

The Catherine and William L. Magistretti Graduate Fellowship, 2019–20

Metro New York Leaders Fellowship, 2018–19

Chiang Ching-kuo Foundation Doctoral Dissertation Fellowship, 2017–18

National Science Foundation Doctoral Dissertation Research Improvement Grant, 2016–17

Finalist, Harvard Academy Scholars Postdoctoral Fellowship, Harvard Academy for International and Area Studies (10 finalists chosen from 1,139 applicants), 2016

Dr. C.F. Koo and Cecilia Koo Fellowship for Outstanding Graduate Student in East Asian Studies, UC Berkeley Institute of East Asian Studies, 2017

Long-Ling Hsiao Chu and Chao Chi Chu Fellowship in Chinese Studies, UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies, 2017

UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies Dissertation Fellowship, 2016–17

Helen Gan and Richard Aston Fellowship, 2015–16

UC Berkeley Institute of East Asian Studies Haas Junior Scholars Program for Doctoral Candidates, 2015–16

China Times Cultural Foundation Young Scholars Award, 2015

Leo Lowenthal Fellowship, UC Berkeley Department of Sociology, 2015

Republic of China East Asian Fellowship, UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies, 2015

Taiwanese-American Foundation of Boston University Fellowship, 2015

UC Berkeley Center for Chinese Studies Summer Research Grant, 2014

UC Berkeley Department of Sociology Small Research Grant, 2013–14

Institute for Humane Studies, Bernard Marcus Fellowship, 2013–14

UC Berkeley Graduate Division Summer Grant, 2013

Institute for Humane Studies, Baxter Fellowship, 2012–13

Yale-China Association Teaching Fellowship, 2008–10

Teaching

Classical Sociological Theory (fall 2026, fall 2024, fall 2022, fall 2021)

Contemporary Sociological Theory (spring 2026, spring 2024)

Historical Sociology (fall 2026, spring 2023)

Sociology of Language (spring 2026, spring 2025)

Political Sociology (fall 2025, fall 2023)

Nations and Nationalism (fall 2025, spring 2023, spring 2022)

Field Research in Contemporary China (spring 2024)

Race and Ethnicity (fall 2023)

Contemporary American Society (spring 2022)

Service

TO THE DISCIPLINE Peer reviewer, *Journal of Asian Studies*, *Social Problems*, *International Journal of Comparative Sociology*, *Sungkyun Journal of East Asian Studies*, *Sociology of Development*, *Journal of Asian Sociology*, *International Journal of Comparative Sociology*

TO THE
DEPARTMENT Graduate Studies Committee (2024–)
International Programs Committee (2023–)
Undergraduate Studies Committee (2023–24, 2026–)
Curriculum Committee (2023–24)
Doctoral Studies Committee (2022–23)
Colloquium and Proseminar Coordinator (fall 2024, fall 2022)

Languages Mandarin Chinese (advanced fluency)
Spanish (fluent)

**Professional
affiliations** American Sociological Association
Association for Asian Studies
Yale-China Association

Other skills Organist (St. John's Episcopal Cathedral, Taipei, 2021–present; St. Paul's
Episcopal Church, Walnut Creek, CA, 2025–present)
Choral singer, baritone (Taipei Philharmonic Chorus 2021–22; St. Mark's
Episcopal Church, 2013–2020)

References

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MARA LOVEMAN

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PAMELA CROSSLEY

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Professor of Asian and Middle Eastern Studies
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